

Table 1: A comparison between VirtualBox, Xen, KVM and VMware Player

Characteristics	Virtual Box	Xen	KVM	VMware Player
Licence	Public Licence Version 2	Proprietary	Public Licence Version 2	Proprietary; it is also available free of charge for personal, non-commercial use
Created by	Earlier Innotek; now supported by Oracle	Earlier Xen-source; now supported by Citrix Systems	Earlier Qumranet; now supported by Red Hat	VMware
CPU support	X866, Intel	X86, x86-64	X86, Power PC,	X86-64
OS support	Linux, FreeBSD, Solaris, Windows	GNU/Linux and other UNIX-like OSs	Linux, Illumos, FreeBSD	Linux, Windows

successfully, you will get the VirtualBox dashboard. We are now ready to create a virtual machine in the VirtualBox.

Creating a VM in VirtualBox

To create a virtual machine in VirtualBox, click on the New button. Provide a name for the virtual machine, select the operating system type, and select the version. In our case, we will create a CentOS 6.7 virtual machine.

Click on *Next* and select the memory size (in MB) for the CentOS 6.7 virtual machine.

Click on *Next* again. Configure the settings for the hard disk; in our case, we will select 'Create a Virtual Hard Disk' now. Click on *Create*. Select the hard disk file type as *VDI-VirtualBox disk image*.

Click on *Next*. Select a dynamically allocated size for efficiency as it will use space only as per requirements. Click on *Next*. Keep the file location and size as it is. Click on *Create*. You will now have a newly created virtual machine in VirtualBox on the desktop.

Click on *Start*. In the startup disk, provide the CentOS 6.7 ISO.

Click on *Start* and follow the rest of the process for a normal CentOS installation.

Once the virtual machine is ready and we want to preserve

the installation (or if we want to create a similar type of virtual machine), we can clone it. Go to the left sidebar and click on *Clone*. Provide the new VM's name and click on *Next*.

Select a clone type. We will select a *Full Clone* and not a linked clone. A full clone will create an exact copy of the original machine, and it will include all virtual hard disk files too in the process. In the case of a linked clone, it won't copy the virtual hard disk files but a new virtual machine will be tied to the original virtual hard disk files. Click on *Clone* and then on *Done*.

To verify and edit the different settings available in the VirtualBox VM, click on the virtual machine and select *Settings*. In each case, verify and/or edit settings.

To verify what files are created for the VM, go to `C:\Users\<UserName>\VirtualBox VMs` and verify all files. 

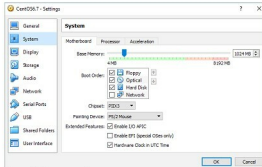


Figure 6: System settings

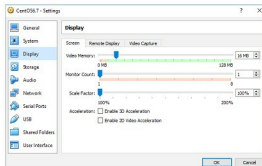


Figure 7: VirtualBox display settings

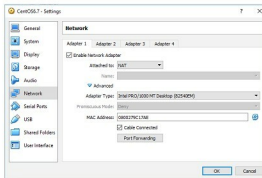


Figure 8: Network settings

By: Priyanka Agashe and Mitesh Soni

Priyanka Agashe is a senior software engineer. She loves to read books and her professional interests include testing, Oracle apps, electronics and robotics.

Mitesh Soni is a technical specialist. He loves to write about new technologies. Blog: <http://etutorialsworld.com/>.

References

- [1] <https://www.virtualbox.org/>
- [2] <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/VirtualBox>